

THE REFILLING

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Leviticus 24:1-4 (NKJV) “*Then the LORD spoke to Moses, saying: ² “Command the children of Israel that they bring to you pure oil of pressed olives for the light, to make the lamps burn continually. ³ Outside the veil of the Testimony, in the tabernacle of meeting, Aaron shall be in charge of it from evening until morning before the LORD continually; it shall be a statute forever in your generations. ⁴ He shall be in charge of the lamps on the pure gold lamp stand before the LORD continually.”*

Numbers 4:16 (NKJV) “*The appointed duty of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest is the oil for the light, the sweet incense, the daily grain offering, the anointing oil, the oversight of all the tabernacle, of all that is in it, with the sanctuary and its furnishings.”*

1 Samuel 3:1-3 (KJV) *“And the child Samuel ministered unto the LORD before Eli. And the word of the LORD was precious in those days; there was no open vision. ²And it came to pass at that time, when Eli was laid down in his place, and his eyes began to wax dim, that he could not see; ³And ere the lamp of God went out in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was...”*

INTRO: Today is Pentecost Sunday.

Pentecost means fiftieth day: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Pentecost is historically and symbolically related to the Jewish Harvest Festival of Shavuot, which commemorates God giving the Ten Commandments fifty day's after the Exodus. The Harvest Festival of Shavuot is the equivalent of our Thanksgiving holiday.
- Pentecost is celebrated on the tenth day following ascension Thursday. After the Resurrection Jesus walked the earth for forty days before ascending into Heaven from Bethany's launching pad. Ten day's later the Holy Spirit was poured out in the

Upper Room, thus the writer of Acts declared, “*When the Day of Pentecost* (Fiftieth day) *was fully come...*”

- Pentecost commemorates the descent of the Holy Spirit upon the Apostles and other followers of Jesus. This outpouring happened in an Upper Room in Jerusalem, on the fiftieth day after the resurrection of Jesus.
- Pentecost is the birthday of the New Testament Church. The Church was not born until the outpouring of the Holy Spirit on the Day of Pentecost.

Throughout the entirety of God’s Word we see the relationship between oil and the Holy Spirit. This truth is so plain that even the non-Pentecostal writers’ commentaries draw a parallel between the two!

I have read to you a number of scriptures that emphasize the importance of oil in Old Testament worship: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Oil was used to fuel the light...

- Oil was used to anoint individuals...
- Oil was used in the bread and the wafers...

When reading about Old Testament worship one is constantly confronted with the word oil! You might say the Old Testament was a well-oiled machine.

Oil is equally significant in the New Testament. When studying the Bible one must keep in mind, oil always represents the Holy Spirit.

One of the most important uses for oil in Old Testament worship was to keep the lamp burning in the place of worship. Notice Leviticus 24:2 (NKJV) “*Command the children of Israel that they bring to you pure oil of pressed olives for the light, to make the lamps burn continually.*” This scripture tells us that the lamp was to burn continually. The lamp was to be serviced in the mornings and in the evenings! Where there is no oil, there is no light.

Who was the responsible for making sure there was oil for the lamps in the Holy place?

Exodus 27:20-21 (NKJV) ***“And you shall command the children of Israel that they bring you pure oil of pressed olives for the light, to cause the lamp to burn continually. ²¹ In the tabernacle of meeting, outside the veil which is before the Testimony, Aaron and his sons shall tend it from evening until morning before the LORD. It shall be a statute forever to their generations on behalf of the children of Israel.”*** Let me make this a little clearer...

Numbers 4:16 (NKJV) ***“The appointed duty of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest is the oil for the light, the sweet incense, the daily grain offering, the anointing oil, the oversight of all the tabernacle, of all that is in it, with the sanctuary and its furnishings.”***

This scripture along with Exodus 27:21 makes us aware of the fact that upon Aaron, Eleazar and their successors was laid the responsibility for all the material and appliances for divine worship. It was a special responsibility for the priest to see to the material for the daily meat

offering, and especially to see to the incense and to the reservoir of oil! Woe to the preacher who allows the oil to diminish in God's house and among God's people. It is the responsibility of the preacher to keep the oil of the Holy Spirit flowing in the church and to consistently create a hunger among God's people for the person and the work of the Holy Spirit in each of their lives.

Being filled is important, but continuing to be full is equally important!

It is a fact that if the priest did not keep enough oil in the lamp the light would go out! I want to draw a contrast between some people who failed to keep the oil flowing and some who made sure there was an adequate supply of oil.

I. ELI ALLOWED THE OIL TO RUN DRY...

Eli was a Judge and High Priest in Israel.

Everything we know about Eli's personal life points to the fact that he was a godly man!

However, there are [three alarming facts about](#)

Eli that I want to point out: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Eli lost his vision... Notice 1 Samuel 3:2 (NKJV) *“It came to pass at that time, when Eli was laid down in his place, and his eyes began to wax dim, that he could not see.”* I am not as sure he couldn’t see, as I am, he didn’t want to see! *“Where there is no vision the people perish.”*
- Eli failed to maintain godliness in his home as well as at the church... Eli looked the other way while his sons committed fornication with the women who came to the temple! (David did the same thing with Absalom!) 2 Samuel 18:33 (NKJV) *“Then the king was deeply moved, and went up to the chamber over the gate, and wept. And as he went, he said thus: “O my son Absalom—my son, my son Absalom — if only I had died in your place! O Absalom my son, my son!”*
- Eli allowed the oil to run dry... The most disturbing thing about Eli to me is pointed out in 1 Samuel 3:3 (NKJV) *“And ere the*

lamp of God went out in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was...

Eli didn't do his job! He neglected the refilling! It was literally impossible for the lamp to be refilled on it's own! Someone had to take care of it every morning and every evening! The oil in our personal lives and places of worship is not going to be placed on automatic refill **we must take personal responsibility for the maintenance of the oil reservoir. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

Judgment came to the house of Eli and also to Israel because someone neglected the refilling! 1 Samuel 4:10-11 (NKJV) ***“So the Philistines fought, and Israel was defeated, and every man fled to his tent. There was a very great slaughter, and there fell of Israel thirty thousand foot soldiers. ¹¹ Also the ark of God was captured; and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, died.”*** In one horrible day, Eli, his two sons, and his daughter-in-law died! Before his daughter-in-law died, she named her

son Ichabod. The name Ichabod means “*The Glory of the Lord has departed.*”

What a sad commentary on a family that could have been divinely blessed of the Lord, but someone failed to see the need for refilling the reservoir of oil.

Woe to the person, parent, or pastor who fails to keep the reservoir of oil full!

II. FIVE VIRGINS FAILED TO MAINTAIN AN ADEQUATE AMOUNT OF OIL WHILE FIVE VIRGINS HAD MORE THAN ENOUGH...

[Matthew 25:1-13](#) (NKJV) “*Then the kingdom of heaven shall be likened to ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. ² Now five of them were wise, and five were foolish. ³ Those who were foolish took their lamps and took no oil with them, ⁴ but the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps. ⁵ But while the bridegroom was delayed, they all slumbered and slept. ⁶ “And*

at midnight a cry was heard: ‘Behold, the bridegroom is coming; go out to meet him!’⁷ Then all those virgins arose and trimmed their lamps.⁸ And the foolish said to the wise, ‘Give us some of your oil, for our lamps are going out.’⁹ But the wise answered, saying, ‘No, lest there should not be enough for us and you; but go rather to those who sell, and buy for yourselves.’¹⁰ And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went in with him to the wedding; and the door was shut.¹¹ “Afterward the other virgins came also, saying, ‘Lord, Lord, open to us!’¹² But he answered and said, ‘Assuredly, I say to you, I do not know you.’¹³ “Watch therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour in which the Son of Man is coming.” To me, the most astonishing thing about this passage of Scripture is that the most significant day in the lives of these ten virgins is their wedding day, yet, five of them were ill prepared! They were not ready for the bridegroom for one reason; they had an insufficient amount of oil in their lamps, to go the distance!

One of the most significant features of being continually full of the Holy Spirit is endurance in the face of adversity! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

The reason the five foolish virgins failed to go the distance is because the oil level in their lamps was not a priority!

The virgins who had an adequate supply of oil are referred to in Scripture as “*wise virgins*.”

The bridegroom is coming:

- Wise parents are making sure the family has plenty oil...
- Wise pastors are creating a sense of hunger among their parishioners...
- Wise saints are contending for the fullness of God...
- Wise churches are making room for the work of the Holy Spirit...

Being continually full of the Holy Spirit is a bicycle a person, parent, pastor and church must continually pedal.

I have predetermined to keep my lamp full and the “HOT” light on in my personal life (Krispy Kreme HOT light)!

I refuse for the Nordin family to miss their moment because we failed to be full of the oil of the Holy Spirit!

CT Church will always be a Holy Ghost church as long as I have any influence in the direction of this great church!

III. THE FIRST CENTURY CHURCH CONTINUED IN THE FULLNESS OF THE SPIRIT...

Mark 16:19-20 (NKJV) “*So then, after the Lord had spoken to them, He was received up into heaven, and sat down at the right hand of God. ²⁰ And they went out and preached everywhere, the Lord working with them and confirming the word through the accompanying signs. Amen.*”

Before Pentecost the Disciples of Jesus were a group of wishy-washy, rag-tag misfits, but after

Pentecost they were a determined band of men who stayed full of the Spirit and went the distance. Though the winds of persecution were severe they took the word quit out of their vocabulary and ***“turned their world upside down!”***

Look at the results following this epic Pentecostal event in the Upper Room:

- 3,000 saved the first day... (Acts 2:37-38)
- God added to the church daily such as should be saved... (Acts 2:47)
- 2,000 are saved at Solomon's Porch... (Acts 3:1-4)
- The Samaritans become Christians... (Acts 8:1-12)
- Men and women were baptized following their conversion... (Acts 8:12-13)
- The Ethiopian eunuch is converted... (Acts 8:36-39)
- Saul (Paul) receives Christ... (Acts 9:18)
- The household of Cornelius becomes Christians... (Acts 10:43)
- The people of Antioch are converted... (Acts 11:19-21)
- Sergius Paulus becomes a Christian... (Acts 13:4-12)

- Many Jews and religious proselytes follow Paul and Barnabas at Antioch... (Acts 13:13-48)
- A great multitude of individuals follow Christ at Iconium... (Acts 14:1)
- An undetermined number of people make decisions for Christ at Lystra and Derbe... (Acts 14)
- The Philippian jailer and his family become followers of Christ... (Acts 16)
- Lydia comes to faith in Christ... (Acts 16)
- A great multitude of the Greeks and many of the leading women join themselves to the faith at Thessalonica... (Acts 17:1-‘
- 12)
- The conversion of the Athenians at Mars Hill... (Acts 17:16-34)
- Many Corinthian people are converted... (Acts 18:8)
- At Corinth Aquila and Pricilla follow Jesus... (Acts 18:24-28)
- The twelve disciples of John the Baptist are converted... (Acts 19:1-10)

The first century Church was full of people who went the distance in spite of the odds. [Look at the perseverance of the twelve disciples:](#)

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Andrew died on a cross
- Simon was crucified
- Bartholomew was flayed alive
- James the son of Zebedee was beheaded
- James the son of Alphaeus was beaten to death
- Thomas was run through with a lance
- Mathias was stoned and then beheaded
- Matthew was slain by the sword
- Peter was crucified upside down
- Thaddeus was shot to death with arrows
- Philip was hanged
- Only John made it through alive but he was boiled in oil and exiled to a small island in the middle of the Mediterranean Sea

In these last days, the difference between success and failure will be the level of the oil of the Holy Spirit in the life of the believer.